

Object 1: ARP Helmet

Play the video, encouraging students to look carefully at the object, then reveal the first investigation question.

Question 1: What do you think this object is?

- Encourage students to think about the shape and size of the helmet
- Can they identify the chin strap?
- You could get students to think about the material too - can they work out that it's metal?

Answer: This is a metal helmet from World War Two. These weren't just worn by soldiers, but also by volunteers on the Home Front in Britain.



Question 2: Why do you think Home Front volunteers wore helmets?

- Students might have some pre-existing knowledge of life on the Home Front. Get them to think about life in Britain - was there anything dangerous going on that might require a helmet?
- In particular, students might bring up air raids and the Blitz. Wardens would wear these helmets to protect themselves from falling shrapnel and debris during bombing raids.
- The helmet was part of the Air Raid Precaution (ARP) Warden uniform, so alongside offering protection the helmet also helped to identify individuals as officials.

Answer: Volunteers on the Home Front were sometimes doing dangerous work. Air Raid Wardens and Fire Wardens needed protection from shrapnel and falling debris, so they wore helmets like this one.

These helmets were part of the volunteer uniform, and they were often painted with markings to show which role they held. The uniform and helmet made it obvious that a person was doing official war work.

Summary: So volunteers in Britain wore helmets to protect themselves and show that they were working. Let's have a look at the next object and see if we can learn some more.

Object 2: Scout Photo

Give students a few seconds to look carefully at the image, then reveal the first investigation question.

Question 1: Who is wearing the helmet in this photo? Are they young or old?

- You could see whether students expected to see someone older wearing the helmet - are they surprised to see a young person wearing it?

Answer: The person in the photo is probably aged about 12 or 13. Children helped with the war effort in many different ways, sometimes within their household, and sometimes helping officials with jobs to help the community.

This child isn't working alone - can you spot the others in the background? Sometimes children in the Scouts worked together to do these jobs.



Question 2: What do you think the children are doing?

- Students might notice that the children are painting. Encourage them to think about where they're painting, and what colour paint they are using.
- It's hard to tell in a black and white photo, but students should be able to tell that it's a light-coloured paint.

Answer: The children in this photo are painting white lines along the edge of the road. We have white lines down the middle of our roads today, but not usually along the edges.

Question 3: Why do you think white lines were painted along the edges of roads in Britain during World War Two?

- Students might have knowledge of the blackouts. During the blackouts, households had to make sure that no light could escape from their windows, and streetlights and car headlights were switched off or massively dimmed.
- Encourage students to think about the impact of that on people who needed to travel after dark.

Answer: During the war, there were blackouts during the evenings. This meant that lights, including car headlamps and streetlights, were dimmed or turned off. White lines were painted on the edges of roads to help pedestrians and drivers see where they were going and avoid accidents.

Summary: So children got involved with important jobs during the war. I wonder what other things they did...

Object 3: Scout Badge

Play the video, encouraging students to look carefully at the object, then reveal the first investigation question.

Question 1: Can you work out what this object is?

- Encourage students to read the writing - 'Boy Scouts'.
- Check that your students have heard of the Scouts. You could also ask whether any of them are in the Scouts themselves.

Answer: This is a Scout badge - maybe you have some of these yourself! During the war, only boys were in the Scouts, and girls were in the Guides. Until girls were allowed to join in 1992, the Scouts were known as the Boy Scouts.

Question 2: What do you think the image on the badge represents? Think about the shape and colour.

- The image is quite abstract. Encourage students to think about what the colour red could represent.
- The shape might look like a leaf to some students, but it's actually a flame. Use their thoughts about the colour to prompt them when thinking about the shape.

Answer: The image represents fire. The image had to be simple to make the badge easy and cheap to manufacture. Modern badges are much more detailed.



Question 3: Why do you think a Scout would have been awarded this badge during World War Two?

- During air raids, there were lots of fires caused by the bombing. It was important for Scouts to know what to do if they saw a fire, so that they could help.
- If any of your students are Scouts, they might have their Fire Safety badge. If so, ask them to share what they had to do to earn their badge.

Answer: This badge was a Firefighter badge. Scouts had to know what to do if there was a fire, how to call the fire brigade, and how to put out different types of fire. Scouts can earn a similar badge today, called the Fire Safety badge.

Summary: I wonder why it was so important for Scouts to know about firefighting during the war. Maybe the next object can tell us some more...

Object 4: Fire Bucket

Play the video, encouraging students to look carefully at the object, then reveal the first investigation question.

Question 1: What do you think this object was used for?

- Hopefully students notice the 'FIRE' and 'SAND' wording on the bucket. Encourage them to think about why sand might be used to fight fires.

Answer: This metal bucket contained sand which could be used to put out fires. Incendiary bombs are a highly explosive and flammable type of bomb. In Britain during World War Two, these bombs caused a lot of destruction. If they were sprayed with water, they could explode, so they had to be put out using sand instead.



Question 2: Imagine this bucket being full of sand. How do you think it would feel to carry it?

- Students might say that it would be heavy.
- Encourage them to image the sensation of carrying a heavy bucket. Is it easy or difficult to carry? Is it awkward to walk with? Would you be able to move quickly while carrying it?

Answer: A metal bucket like this would be very heavy when it was full of sand. Scouts volunteered as fire watchers throughout the war. They were responsible for alerting the Fire Wardens to any fires, as well as carrying buckets of sand or water to help those fighting the fires. It was hard, physical work, so it was mostly done by older, teenage Scouts.

Summary: So volunteers in Britain wore helmets to protect themselves and show that they were working. Let's have a look at the next object and see if we can learn some more.

Object 5: First Aid Armband

Play the video, encouraging students to look carefully at the object, then reveal the first investigation question.

Question 1: What do you think this object is?

- If students aren't sure, get them to think about how this could be worn.
- If you've already done Investigation 1, your students will have seen some armbands before.

Answer: This is an armband. Armbands like this were worn by soldiers on the battlefields and by volunteers on the Home Front, to show the wearer's job.

Question 2: You might recognise the symbol in the middle of the badge. Do you know what it means?

- Students might well recognise the red cross. Some might know that it's usually linked to medicine and first aid.

Answer: The symbol is a Red Cross. It's an international symbol of protection which has been used in many conflicts, including World War Two. It was usually worn by medics and first aiders.



Question 3: Why do you think boys in the Scouts might have worn this symbol during World War Two?

- Scouts in the 1940s could earn their First Aid badge, which had the red cross on it. Today, Scouts can earn their Emergency Aid badge, which has a white cross instead.
- You could ask whether any of your students have done first aid training, either in the Scouts or elsewhere.

Answer: Some Scouts had earned their First Aid badge and helped with first aid in Britain. They helped Air Raid Wardens, who wore armbands like this one, and the Scouts wore their badges which also had the red cross in the centre.

Summary: It looks like the Scouts did lots of important things during the war - painting roads, fighting fires, and even first aid! Click the button below to learn more about the role of the Scouts during World War Two.

Once you click the 'Learn More' button, students will be given more information about the Scouts in World War Two by Grace, the character that they met at the beginning of the session.

After that, use the activity prompt and get your students making their own Scout badges, depicting a job that they've learnt about during the session.

Check out the 'adaptations' section of the Teacher Guide page for ideas that could make this session more accessible to a range of students.